that ‘No Government servant shall be a member of, or be otherwise associated with, any political party or any organisation which takes part in politics[,] nor shall he take part in, subscribe in aid of, or assist in any other manner, any political movement or activity.’ After questions on whether this applied to RSS, the Ministry of Home Affairs issued a circular on 30 November 1966 saying, ‘Certain doubts have been raised about Government’s policy with respect to the membership or any participation in the activities of the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh and the Jamaat-e-Islami by Government servants, it is clarified that Government have always held the activities of these two organisations to be of such nature that participation in them by Government servants would attract the provisions of sub-rule (1) of Rule 5 of the CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964. Any government servant, who is a member of or otherwise associated with the aforesaid organisations or with their activities, is liable to disciplinary action.’ The Union government on 28 October 1980 issued another circular which reiterated the 1966 circular. On 27 November 2014, the Narendra Modi government amended the Conduct Rules to add a few clauses to Rule 3(1). One of these said, ‘Every government employee shall at all times maintain political neutrality.’ On 5 January 2016, the Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT) informed *The Indian Express* after an RTI query that ‘No such orders withdrawing the OMs [office memorandums] dated 1966 and 1980 has been issued.’ *The Indian Express* also found that the Himachal Pradesh government on 24 January 2008, the Madhya Pradesh government on 21 August 2006 and Chhattisgarh government in February 2015 had issued instructions saying there were no restrictions on government employees joining RSS activities. The UP government on 20 February 2013 also said that there were no restrictions on RSS membership for government employees. All details quoted from Shyamlal Yadav, ‘Express RTI: The revolving door between BJP, Govt and RSS’, *The Indian Express*, 16 June 2016, https://indianexpress.com/article/explained/narendra-modi-government-rss-manmohan-vaidya-mohan-bhagwat-bjp-and-rss-links-2855319/. Government of India Central Civil Services